Joris Mueller

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Contact Information

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Fields

Political Economy, Development Economics, Economic History

Current Position

Assistant Professor, National University of Singapore 2022 –

Other Affiliations

Affiliate Member, CESifo 2026 –
Academic Partner, Research Training Group "China's Geoeconomic Rise and the Accumulation of Structural Power (China-GRASP)", University of Göttingen and IFW Kiel 2026 –

Education

Ph.D., Economics, Northwestern University 2022
M.A., Economics, Northwestern University 2018
M.Sc., Economics, London School of Economics and Political Science 2016
B.A., Economics, University of Zurich 2014
Summer School, International Relations, Chinese University of Hong Kong 2014
Exchange Student, Economics, Chulalongkorn University Bangkok 2013

Grants

Academic Research Fund Tier 1 (conference), Ministry of Education Singapore 2024 – 2025
Academic Research Fund Tier 1 (research), Ministry of Education Singapore 2024 – 2026
Start-Up Grant, NUS 2022 – 2026
Career Development Grant, Northwestern University 2021
Global Poverty Research Lab, Northwestern University 2017 – 2019

Fellowships & Awards

Center of Economic Studies Visitor Fellowship, LMU Munich 2026
FASS Writing Fellowship, NUS 2026
8th Lindau Nobel Meeting Fellowship, National Research Foundation Singapore 2025
Graduate Dissertation Fellowship, Northwestern University 2021 – 2022
Distinguished Teaching Assistant Award, Northwestern University 2017
Graduate Support Scheme, London School of Economics and Political Science 2015 – 2016

Publications

"The Domestic Political Economy of China's Foreign Aid"
Review of Economics and Statistics, accepted

"State Building in a Diverse Society" (with Ruth Carlitz, Ameet Morjaria and Philip Osafo-Kwaako)
Review of Economic Studies 92, no. 6, 3704-3740, 2025

"The Intensifying Effects of Prolonged Climate Change on Conflict, 1400–1900 CE"
(with Nancy Qian and Murat Iyigun)
AEA Papers and Proceedings, Vol. 114, May 2024

Working Papers

"Public Displays of Alignment" (with Zi Yang Kang, Jaya Wen and Cheryl Wu)

"The Long-Run Effects of Agricultural Productivity on Conflict, 1400–1900" (with Murat Iyigun, Nathan Nunn and Nancy Qian)

"Demining, Development, and Dispossession" (with Daniel Borbely, Mathias Bühler and John Norris)

Work in Progress

"China Goes Hollywood" (with Ruben Durante, Karsten Müller, Carlo Schwarz and Chuyue Tian)

"The Cultural Revolution and the Origins of the Market Economy in China" (with Jingyuan Guo)

"Hegemonic Resource Competition" (with David Kreitmeir and Paul Schaudt)

Presentations, Discussions and Visits

Conference on The Political Economy of Democracy and Dictatorship (PEDD) Muenster, University of Goettingen, KU Leuven, Oxford University, University College London (IFS), Queen's University Belfast, LKY School of Public Policy, SCoPE Workshop Sydney, Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance, LMU Center of Economic Studies (scheduled) 2026

NBER Chinese Economy Working Group Meeting, China in the Global South – Hong Kong-Kiel-Göttingen Workshop, CUHK, HKU, Harvard Business School, Heidelberg University, University of Stuttgart, University of St. Gallen, CSEF-IGIER Bocconi Symposium on Economics and Institutions, ABFER Conference, Lindau Nobel Laureate Meetings 2025

AASLE, AEA ASSA, GRIPS (Tokyo), Hitotsubashi University, China in the Global Economy – Kiel-Göttingen-CEPR Conference, Monash University, NUS, University of Tokyo, University of Melbourne, UNSW, Yokohama National University 2024

ASMS, Barcelona GSE Summer Forum (Development; Political Economy), CESI HKUST, German Development Economics Conference, IFW Kiel, UniCatt Milan PE Workshop, University of Bern, University of Geneva, University of Fribourg, University of Lausanne, University of St. Gallen, University of Zurich, APCC, JADE-CEPR-TIME, NUS ARI, Swiss Economists Abroad Conference 2023

AMES, Asian AEW, MIEDC, NASMES, NBER Chinese Economy Working Group Meeting, Boston University, Federal Reserve Board, HKU, NUS, NYU Shanghai, SMU 2022

NEUDC, Northwestern University, Notre Dame (Devofest), University of Zurich, Swiss Economists Abroad Conference 2021

Refereeing

AEJ: Applied Economics, AEJ: Policy, Belgian National Fund for Scientific Research, European Economic Review, Explorations in Economic History, German Research Foundation, Journal of Asian Economics, Journal of Development Economics, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Journal of Environmental Economics and Management, Journal of International Development, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Public Economics, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Financial Studies, Journal of the European Economic Association, Review of International Organizations, World Development, Review of Economics and Statistics, Verein fuer Socialpolitik, Journal of Politics

Advising

Orlando Betancourt Ramirez, Zehang Chen, Jingyuan Guo, Rita Wang, Naiqi Wang (all co-advisor; current); Yichen Guo, Nuo Lei (committee member; current) 2024 –

Chuyue Tian (predoc; placement: Stanford GSB Economics PhD program)

Anoulat Sinthavy (main advisor; placement: IMF) 2022 – 2024

Teaching

Main instructor, National University of Singapore 2022 – 2026
- Empirical Methods in Applied Economics, PhD (x2)
- Policy Impact Evaluation Methods, MA (x2)
- Programming Tools for Economics, BA (x4)
- AI Tools for Economics, BA
- Econometrics Workshop for Civil Servants, Ministry of Manpower Singapore

Teaching Assistant, Northwestern University 2017 – 2021
- Statistical Decision Analysis, Executive MBA (x6)
- Practical Data Analytics with Advanced Methods, MBA
- Econometrics, undergraduate (x2)
- Law and Economics, undergraduate

Academic Service

FASS PPE-Club Moderator of Panel Discussion on Businesses and AI 2026

Final Round Judge of the National Economics and Financial Management Challenge (NEFMC) 2026

	Organizer of the 1st BREAD Asia Conference on Development Economics	2024
	Applied economics advising breakfast founder and organizer	2024 – 2025
	Applied economics seminar and brownbag lunch organizer	2022 – 2024
Other Professional Experience	Research Assistant, Prof. Nancy Qian, Northwestern University	2018 – 2021
	Embassy of Switzerland, Bangkok, Thailand Academic graduate intern in the diplomatic section (full-time)	2015
	Finatris AG, Zurich, Switzerland Project manager in a financial technology start-up (part-time)	2014 – 2015
	Dolder Corporate Finance, Zurich, Switzerland M&A project associate (part-time)	2012 – 2013
	UBS, Zurich, Switzerland International Wealth Management talent development program (full-time)	2007 – 2011